Hackathon Platform – Infra Cost Estimate (MVP Phase)
Prepared by: Kishlaya (System Architect)

Here's a transparent estimate of the infrastructure cost to build and run the hackathon platform for the first edition. This covers **development + hackathon period + a small buffer month** so we don't have to constantly upgrade/downgrade plans.

I'm proposing that you transfer this budget to me as mentioned in call, and I'll handle purchasing and managing the subscriptions (Supabase, Resend, Vercel, domain, analytics).

1. Email Infrastructure – Resend

- **Service:** Resend (transactional email API)
- **Usage:** registration emails, team invites, submission confirmations, result notifications
- **Plan:** Pro – **$20/month**
- **Duration:** 5 months
- **Cost: $20 × 5 = $100**

(Covers up to ~50,000 emails/month, which is more than enough for >10k participants.)

2. Database / Auth / Storage – Supabase

- **Service:** Supabase (Postgres + Auth + Storage)
- **Usage:** core database, auth, file storage for submissions
- **Plan:** Pro – **$25/month**
- **Duration:** 5 months
- **Cost: $25 × 5 = $125**

(Pro plan gives us a production- grade Postgres instance with higher limits and better stability for peaks.)

3. Hosting – Vercel

- **Service:** Vercel (Next.js hosting)
- **Usage:** hosting frontend + API routes (single codebase)
- **Plan:** Pro – **$20/month** (1 active seat)
- **Duration:**
  - **2 months definitely needed** (build + launch)
  - **+1 month optional** (post- hackathon buffer / iteration)
- **Cost range:**
  - Minimum: **$20 × 2 = $40**
  - With optional extra month: up to **$20 × 5 = $100** (if we keep Pro on longer)

(Hobby plan is free, but Pro removes limits and is more appropriate for a serious global hackathon platform.)

For budgeting, we can assume **$40–$100** depending on how long we keep Pro active.

4. Domain

- **Service:** Domain (e.g. .com)
- **Usage:** primary public URL for the platform
- **Cost: $25** (1 year)

(Actual .com domains usually sit in the $15–20 range; budgeting $25 is a safe upper bound including taxes, SSL and registrar variation.)

5. Analytics – Plausible

- **Service:** Plausible Analytics
- **Usage:** privacy- friendly analytics for visits, conversions, funnel
- **Plan & usage:**
  - $9/month if we stay under **10k pageviews/month**

    - $19–39/month if we reach higher traffic (up to ~200k pageviews/month)
- **Budget assumption: $50 total** over the active months, or more then $50 if you also want to have an eye on analytics, **max $100**
    - This covers a mix of lower and potentially higher traffic months during the hackathon.

6. GitHub Organization – Team Plan

- **Service:** GitHub Team (for organization repo)
- **Usage:** private org, branch protections, reviews for core dev team
- **Plan:** GitHub Team – roughly **$4/user/month**.
- **Assumption:** 5 developers with access, for 2 months during active build
- **Cost:** approximately **$4 × 5 × 2 = $40**

This keeps collaboration under an organization account instead of a personal repo, with proper access control.

7. Miscellaneous / Rounding / Fees

- **Item:** Payment processor GST, FX rounding, pricing quirks
- **Reason:**
    - Most services bill in **X.99** formats, and payment gateways add small currency conversion spreads.
    - There may also be minor variations in tax/VAT and invoice rounding.
- **Buffer: $20**

This gives us a cushion so small deltas (like $0.99 extra here and there) don't break the budget.

7. Summary

Using the above numbers:

- **Resend (5 months):** $100
- **Supabase (5 months):** $125

- **Vercel Pro (2–5 months):** $40–$100
- **Domain (1 year):** $25
- **Plausible (est.):** $50 - $100
- **Github Team (2months.):** $40
- **Misc. buffer (GST/FX/rounding):** $20

Total budget range:

- **Lower bound (shorter Vercel usage):** around **$400**
- **Upper bound (longer Vercel usage + Shared Analytics):** up to **~$510**

If you're okay, you can transfer a single amount within this range (e.g. the upper bound), and I'll handle:

- Activating Pro plans
- Keeping invoices/receipts organized
- Making sure we stay within or under this budget while shipping the platform quickly and reliably.